

Project 8

Course Code and Name: MSJ 2241 Interpersonal and Intercultural Communication

Project Name: Navigating Diversity: A Brief Summary of Approach to Intercultural Communication Research

Project Type: Digital Story

Project Theme: N/A

Semester of Submission: Fall2241

Project Description:

This project is an audio-visual presentation created by our team on Intercultural and Interpersonal Communication. We produced a video explaining the importance of cultural understanding and used Bangladesh's rickshaw and rickshaw art as examples of intercultural communication and cultural exchange.

Project Justification:

This project highlights the importance of respecting different cultures and promoting cultural diversity. It also shows how local traditions can gain global recognition through effective communication.



YouTube Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cq06bfXVQM8>



Clip 1



Clip 2



Final Project Report

Course Title:

Interpersonal and Intercultural Communication

Code: MSJ 11124

Submitted To:

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Project Title:

"Navigating Diversity: A Brief Summary of Approach to Intercultural Communication Research"

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Section 1

"Navigating Diversity: A Brief Summary of Approach to Intercultural Communication Research"

Culture:

Culture can be defined as some group of people or people living in the same location when they share their values, ethics, food habits, and taste in music, poetry, sports, fashion, etc. All this can be expressed through art, language, drama, ritual or traditional activities, and living style which includes almost everything. Cultural elements do not exist in isolation; rather, they constitute a linked web that makes sense within the context of the community. Even if they don't directly discuss them, members have a common awareness of these elements. Culture is dynamic and ever-changing. It evolves and changes over time as a result of internal and external causes. Old ideas and practices can be replaced, while new ones can emerge. Expressed through many channels: There are numerous methods to express one's culture. Language, music, art, dancing, food, clothing, rituals, and ceremonies are just a few of the ways cultures are communicated and experienced.

Understanding Intercultural Communication in a Globalized World

Intercultural communication is the most important thing in today's world, where division is at its best. People have trust issues because of miscommunication or misunderstanding of a variety of cultural differences. Effective intercultural communication requires cultural sensitivity, awareness, and the ability to adapt communication strategies to foster understanding and minimize misunderstandings. Intercultural communication can lead to collaboration, innovation, and global harmony. It helps break down stereotypes, promotes inclusivity, and contributes to a more cooperative and interconnected global community.

Understanding intercultural communication is critical in today's world, and its importance is growing as our world gets more interconnected. Here are some of the main reasons:

Building stronger relationship ideas to communicate successfully across cultural borders is critical for building solid relationships in a world with different populations. Understanding varied

communication styles, nonverbal clues, and cultural values can aid in the prevention of misunderstandings, the development of trust, and the promotion of collaboration.

Globalization has expanded interaction between people from other cultures in a variety of circumstances, including business, education, and travel. Understanding multicultural communication allows us to smoothly navigate these relationships and prevent conflict. Cultural barriers can be broken down through effective intercultural communication, which promotes tolerance and acceptance of variety.

Cultural barriers can be broken down through effective intercultural communication, which promotes tolerance and acceptance of variety. We can create a more inclusive and harmonious world by recognizing and understanding other points of view. Improving professional success: In today's international workforce, the ability to effectively connect with people from diverse cultures is a vital skill. Understanding intercultural communication can provide you with a competitive advantage in the employment market and aid you in your international commercial operations.

Ethnocentrism and cultural relativism

The conviction that one's own culture is superior to all others is known as ethnocentrism. It's natural to use our cultural norms, beliefs, and rituals as a yardstick for measuring other civilizations. Ethnocentrism plays an important role here. We often think of taking for granted that what is ours or something that is native or can be related is far more superior to what is alien new or different. This type of idea creates room for division, racist ideas, and stereotypes. To get rid of ethnocentrism, cultural relativism is very important. Ethnocentrism is a normal human characteristic. It is something we cannot simply escape. We may, however, become conscious of our own biases and seek to overcome them. Ethnocentrism is the polar opposite of cultural relativism. It is the concept that all civilizations are equal and should be evaluated on their own merits. Finding a happy medium between ethnocentrism and cultural relativism is critical. We must be proud of our own culture while also respecting other people's cultures.

Cultural relativism is the concept that cultural practices, beliefs, and values should be understood and judged in the context in which they are found. It stresses the unfairness and inaccuracy of assessing a culture based on the standards of another. Understanding and respecting a religious

group's food preferences within their cultural setting. Recognizing that "beauty" is culturally defined and recognizing varied standards of appearance. Cultural relativism does not require us to discard our values or ideas. It's about accepting that there are many various ways to live and experience the world and that we can all learn and grow from one another. We can make the world a more open and understanding place by embracing cultural relativism. Accepting that signatures are not universal greetings and adjusting to varied greeting customs in many cultures.

When we start to see other cultures as not competitive or comparable but rather respected for what it is. Only then societies can collaborate and move forward with diversity and communication for a better world.

The Importance of Intercultural and Cross-Cultural Communication

In our digital world, it's very easy to communicate in linguistic ways. But when communication takes place in different cultures and different values of people we feel like in an interconnected world. It leads towards a more liberal, tolerant, and free diverse world. Where everyone is equal and treated well regardless of race, ethnicity, religion gender, etc. The importance of intercultural and cross-cultural communication cannot be stressed in today's interconnected world. This type of communication is critical for promoting understanding and collaboration among people from various origins and cultures. It enables individuals to navigate cultural barriers, encouraging global harmony and effective engagement. In summary, the ability to engage in intercultural communication is a critical talent for bridging cultural gaps and maintaining successful connections in our increasingly diverse and linked global community.

This can be related to the topic which we have chosen. Rickshaw As Bangladeshi we are familiar with it, right? But it's also popular in South Asia and also in the UK, and the USA these days. They come in various forms, such as cycle rickshaws pulled by a cyclist(Bangladesh, china), or hand-pulled rickshaws(in Kolkata, japan), where a person pulls the cart on foot. While traditional rickshaws are still in use, some places have also introduced electric or motorized versions for improved efficiency and reduced physical strain on the puller. The Western world has adapted to the updated version of it. They see it as eco-friendly and also a source of income or outsourcing. In the Deshi, culture rickshaw added its value in the 19th century and continues. When Japanese people invented it, it was a Japanese thing in the Early 18th century. But the idea migrated here in

Bengal. The intercultural fact that the rickshaw became deeply embedded in the culture of Bangladesh. It not only served as a practical means of transportation but also became an iconic symbol of the country's streetscape.



Especially the art that every rickshaw carries behind its chain shield is a very desi thing. It portrays many of our local cultural aspects. It is now very much popular around the world. Many people worldwide come to Bangladesh just to collect the art behind rickshaw chain shields. Just recently it has gained the status of UNESCO World Heritage Work. Cross-cultural plays a very big role here. But cultural relativism is also a factor here cause normal people in Bangladesh see rickshaws as middle-class people's transportation not that premium or luxurious. The art is also been neglected for years. But those who love art and understand the way artworks attract them very much. They are even ready to buy with a good amount for their taste in art. The other side doesn't see art as middle-class people's transportation or anything think they see the artworks as it should be valued.

It is now available in the UK, USA, Canada, Germany, and Italy. Many of the painting has been shown in art exhibit around the world linking cross-cultural appropriation. Artists from different countries learned about this painting style and exchanged thoughts on painting. It also promotes our local culture in depth without saying a single word. It's all about just painted art.

Despite their problems, Dhaka's rickshaws provide a unique opportunity for intercultural contact. We can gain a better understanding of Dhaka's dynamic culture and people if we approach these exchanges with respect, sensitivity, and a willingness to learn. Remember that communication is a two-way street. As passengers, we can acquire a few Bengali phrases, express gratitude for the drivers' understanding, and be aware of the power dynamics at work. By doing so, we can transform a simple rickshaw ride into a valuable intercultural exchange.

So, the next time you ride through Dhaka's streets on a rickshaw, don't only think of it as a ride. Consider it an opportunity to network, learn, and experience the city through a different lens. After all, the beauty of intercultural communication is that it is a journey rather than a destination.

Reference:

- <https://www.middlebury.edu/language-schools/blog/language-learning-why-intercultural-communication-important#:~:text=The%20capacity%20to%20communicate%20with,%2C%20social%20norms%2C%20and%20habits.>
- <https://www.idrinstitute.org/resources/intercultural-communication/>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RXwxg-6dUbE>
- <https://en.banglapedia.org/index.php/Rickshaw>
- <https://www.britannica.com/technology/rickshaw-vehicle>

Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- Learned the importance of intercultural communication and cultural diversity.
- Improved my video production, teamwork, and presentation skills.
- Understood how local culture can be shared with a global audience.